

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel Architect | Defender | Security Operations | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, installing and configuring Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender solutions across enterprise environments at technical expert level. I bring architect-level expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), including end-to-end Sentinel architecture design, log source onboarding, detection rule development using Kusto Query Language (KQL), and SOAR playbook automation. I have led the deployment and ongoing optimisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user enterprise. I am experienced at discussing complex security challenges with technical and non-technical stakeholders, providing technical knowledge to review and resolve issues, and delivering secure, effective solutions. My background in enterprise cyber security and identity operations gives me the grounding to provide expert professional services to customers as a senior Sentinel and Defender consultant.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel Architect:** Design, installation, configuration and ongoing optimisation of Microsoft Sentinel; KQL-based detection rule and threat hunting query development; SOAR playbook automation; log source onboarding and data connector management; workspace architecture
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; configuration, policy management, advanced hunting, and integration with Sentinel
- **SIEM/SOAR Design:** End-to-end SIEM architecture design and implementation; Splunk/SPL; CrowdStrike Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM); Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development; detection engineering
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/Prevent/Insight/Discover; Tanium; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; vulnerability scan and remediation lifecycle
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK framework-aligned IR; investigation, containment, eradication and post-incident review
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; SOAR automation; detection-as-code; automated alert triage
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Security Operations:** Alert triage, threat hunting, security posture management, reporting and stakeholder communication

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) – Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Architect, design and configure Microsoft Sentinel as the enterprise SIEM/SOAR platform; manage all data connector onboarding, workspace architecture decisions and KQL-based detection logic at technical expert level.
- Design and build Sentinel SOAR playbooks using Logic Apps and Power Automate to automate incident triage, enrichment and response workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Configure, optimise and manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000+ users; integrate all Defender signals into Microsoft

Sentinel for unified incident management.

- Lead detection engineering by writing and maintaining a library of KQL detection rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, enabling proactive threat hunting and systematic threat detection improvements.
- Discuss complex security issues with senior stakeholders and technology leadership, providing technical knowledge and expert recommendations to review and resolve security challenges.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) alongside Microsoft Defender, providing multi-layered endpoint protection and enriched threat intelligence for Sentinel correlation.
- Lead the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Pentra BAS and AppCheck; onboard vulnerability data into Sentinel dashboards for unified risk visibility.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); integrate PAM audit logs into Sentinel for privileged account monitoring and insider threat detection.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) – Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Configured and managed Microsoft Sentinel detection rules and incident workflows; performed alert triage, threat hunting and incident escalation.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) policies, reviewed threat alerts and conducted advanced hunting queries to identify attacker activity across the estate.
- Supported the design and configuration of Sentinel data connectors and log ingestion from multiple sources including Azure AD, Microsoft 365, CrowdStrike Falcon and network security tools.
- Administered Entra ID and Azure AD including Conditional Access, MFA and SSO; worked closely with the identity team to resolve access control issues and reduce attack surface.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM administration; maintained privileged session audit trails and connected PAM logs to Sentinel for monitoring.
- Produced Sentinel-based security dashboards and metrics reports for the security leadership team, providing clear visibility of the threat landscape.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) – IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Delivered security engineering across a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, covering endpoint protection, identity management, and security monitoring.
- Supported implementation of Microsoft Defender and security monitoring tooling; assisted with Security Operations Centre (SOC) processes and alert handling.
- Managed MFA and SSO configurations for cloud-hosted business application access; administered Active Directory and Group Policy.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and produced remediation recommendations aligned to CIS Controls and ISO 27001.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Architected and implemented a Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR solution from design through to production, onboarding 30+ log sources and establishing the end-to-end detection and response capability for a large public sector organisation.
- Developed a KQL detection rule library covering 50+ threat scenarios aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing false-positive volume by over 40% and enabling consistent, high-quality threat hunting.
- Led the full deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000+ users, delivering an integrated, Sentinel-connected defence platform.
- Designed and automated SOAR incident response playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing manual analyst effort on routine triage tasks by a significant margin and improving MTTR.
- Integrated CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM with Microsoft Sentinel to provide enriched, correlated threat detection across endpoint, identity and cloud control planes.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM log integration with Sentinel, providing real-time privileged account monitoring and insider threat detection capability.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)